military apparatus from the mid-1990s onward specifically for use against India. State support, which began around 1993 and increased significantly during the ensuing years, included: funding; assistance with organizing; combat training; campaign guidance; provision of weapons and kit, including sophisticated communications equipment; hides, launching pads and fire support for cadres crossing into Indian-administered Kashmir; assistance infiltrating into or exfiltrating out of India and other countries; intelligence on targets and threats; diplomatic support; and, of course, safe haven and protection in Pakistan.[61] The group's training primer reads as if the army co-authored it, which may not be too far from the case. That primer calls for a drawn-out war with India to deplete the country's manpower, exhaust its security forces and diminish their morale, and exploit weaknesses in the government's supply chain.[62] Army and ISI personnel were present at Lashkar's training camps, where they helped to develop the training regimen designed to realize these objectives and to train the group's trainers.[63] According to one former member who left the group in 1998, coordination was so close that representatives from the army, ISI and Lashkar would sit at the table together to plan attacks and strategy.[64]

With Pakistani assistance Lashkar was a recognized force in Indian-administered Kashmir by the late 1990s. According to the interrogation report of Abdul Razzak Masood, an Indian who joined Lashkar toward the end of the decade, when he went to join the Kashmir jihad he initially trained with HuM. However, he quickly moved to Lashkar. Masood explained this switch to his interrogators, saying 'the strength of Harkat group was very meager when compared to LeT.'[65] By this time the group was also becoming increasingly self-sufficient. This owed to the growth of its infrastructure, explored in the following chapter, as well as to its recruitment of army and ISI officers who joined the group following their retirement from active service.[66] In addition to those who joined full-time, there are reports of government and military officials taking leave for several months to fight with Lashkar.[67] These men increased Lashkar's self-sufficiency in terms of its decision-making capabilities, while also providing a boost to its organizational and operational capabilities.

While Lashkar was thriving by the end of the decade, then-Prime Minister of Pakistan Nawaz Sharif was ready to pursue a less militaristic